



# PRD Review

Week 3 • Day 5 • Mini-Capstone Ships Today

TPM Academy



## Day 5 Objectives

- Conduct a **structured peer review** using the Friday rubric — specific findings, not impressions
- Receive feedback in person with curiosity, not defense
- Write a **review-resolution log** showing what was adopted, deferred, or rebutted
- Pass a **secondary review** conducted by a different reviewer
- Ship the **mini-capstone deliverable**: signed-off Product Requirements Document (PRD) + review trail



# Today's Cadence (different)

| Clock                | Block                                     |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| 09:00 – 09:15        | Opening; pairings posted                  |
| <b>09:15 – 10:45</b> | <b>Primary review round 1</b>             |
| 10:45 – 11:00        | Break                                     |
| 11:00 – 12:00        | Author response + clarifying conversation |
| 12:00 – 13:00        | Lunch                                     |
| <b>13:00 – 14:30</b> | <b>Revisions</b>                          |
| 14:30 – 14:45        | Break                                     |
| <b>14:45 – 15:45</b> | <b>Secondary review</b>                   |
| 15:45 – 16:00        | Wrap + sign-off                           |

# The Pairing Structure

Each PRD is read by **two** primary reviewers in the morning, then by a **different** secondary reviewer in the afternoon.

| PRD authors | AM primary reviewers | PM secondary |
|-------------|----------------------|--------------|
| A           | B, C                 | D            |
| B           | C, D                 | E            |
| C           | D, E                 | F            |
| D           | E, F                 | A            |

Each quad has 3 reading roles today: primary  $\times 2$  in AM, secondary  $\times 1$  in PM.  
Plus owning your own PRD throughout.

# Block 1 — The Friday Rubric

What "exemplary" looks like, dimension by dimension



# The Rubric (0–4 per dimension)

Score each dimension 0–4; strategy linkage checks goals against your North Star (NS) and key performance indicators (KPIs):

| Dimension          | Weight | Exemplary (4)                                               |
|--------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Problem clarity    | 20%    | Engineer could scope without clarifying call                |
| AC testability     | 25%    | Each AC implementable + falsifiable; covers happy/sad/weird |
| NFR completeness   | 20%    | 5 categories present; each has a defended target            |
| Strategy linkage   | 15%    | Goals tie to Week-2 NS / KPIs / journey friction            |
| Risk honesty       | 10%    | Real risks named; "no risks" is fail                        |
| Writing discipline | 10%    | Clear, specific; no AI-generic prose                        |

**Score thresholds:**  $\geq 3.0$  ships as-is. 2.0–2.9 ships with named gaps.  $< 2.0 \rightarrow$  facilitator intervenes.

# What Good Reviewing Looks Like

## Bad review

- "Section 2 is unclear"
- "acceptance criteria (AC) could be more specific"
- No section citations
- Praise is generic

## Good review

- "Section 2 doesn't say small- or large-shop dispatchers — changes scope"
- "AC #4: 'handles errors gracefully' → 'Given timeout >5s, when user retries, then queued for offline submit'"
- Every finding cites a section
- Praise is specific

**The rule:** if you say "could be more specific", you write the specific version.



# The Review Document

```
# Review of PRD: <feature name>
**Reviewers:** <reviewer quad>
**PRD authors:** <author quad>

## Scores (0-4 per dimension)
| Dimension | Score | One-line rationale |
| ... |

**Total:** [weighted sum, out of 4.0]

## Top 3 strengths (specific)
1. ...

## Top 5 specific findings
1. Section ____ – <label>
- What we observed:
- Why it matters:
- Suggested fix:

## Open questions for the author quad
```

**Three strengths is required.** Honest praise builds the trust that lets the harder feedback land.



# Activity 1 — Primary Review (AM)

Two reviewing quads per PRD • 90 minutes

- 0–10 min: read Sections 1–5; score Problem clarity + Strategy linkage
- 10–35 min: read Sections 6–7; score AC + non-functional requirements (NFRs)
- 35–55 min: read Sections 8–11; score Risk honesty
- 55–75 min: write review document
- 75–90 min: refine + submit (no coordination with the other reviewer quad)



10 + 25 + 20 + 20 + 15

# Block 2 — Author Response + Clarifying Conversation

In person; not about scores; about understanding

# The Conversation

1. **5 min:** each reviewing quad gives a 2-min spoken summary
2. **20 min:** author quad asks — "Walk us through finding #3"; "Which AC was worst?"
3. **25 min:** reviewers ask — "We assumed X; right?"; "We disagreed about Y; what's your take?"
4. **10 min:** author quad **summarizes what they heard** — adopt / defer / push back

**Not about negotiating scores.** About clarifying findings and surfacing implicit feedback that didn't make the written review.

# Common Conversation Pitfalls

| Pitfall                       | What to do                                                    |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Author gets defensive         | "What's the version of this finding you would accept?"        |
| Reviewer softens at the table | "What did you write? Stand by it or revise."                  |
| Drift to debating the *idea*  | "Today is the *PRD*. Critique the document, not the feature." |
| Authors skip the summary      | Force it: "Tell us what you heard, in 60 seconds."            |

## Activity 2 — Author Response Conversation

Three quads (author + 2 reviewing quads) • 60 minutes

- 5 min: reviewer summaries
- 20 min: author quad asks
- 25 min: reviewers ask
- 10 min: author quad summarizes what they heard



5 + 20 + 25 + 10

# Block 3 — Revisions

Adopt / Defer / Push back — with reasoning

# The Three-Bucket Approach

## Adopt

Change the PRD.  
Note in resolution log  
*what* you changed.

## Defer

Track elsewhere  
(issue / ticket /  
follow-up). Note  
*where* in the log.

## Push back

Decline the change.  
Note *why* in the log.  
The most senior  
signal.

**The trust signal:** Push-back entries with reasoning. Show the quad thought, not just complied.



# Worked Resolution Log

```
## Friday review-resolution log

**Reviewers (AM):** Quad B, Quad C
**Total scores:** B = 3.1 / C = 2.8 → addressed below

### Adopted
- B/Finding 2: Section 6 AC #4 was untestable. Rewrote with explicit observable.
- C/Finding 1: Section 7 missing Compliance NFR. Added retention + audit-trail.
- B/Finding 5: Section 9 risk "tech adoption" had no mitigation. Added toggle.

### Deferred
- C/Finding 3: Multi-shop manager view. DEFERRED to Section 11 + ticket.

### Pushed back
- B/Finding 4: Reviewer suggested splitting AC #2; declined because the
"ands" describe one observable state. Reasoning preserved here.
```



## Activity 3 — Revisions

Quads • 90 minutes

Sort findings; revise in priority order (coherence, then specificity, then prose); update the resolution log.

- 15 min: sort findings into Adopt / Defer / Push back
- 60 min: revise in priority order
- 15 min: update resolution log + flip status to "Revised — secondary pending"



15 + 60 + 15

# Block 4 — Secondary Review + Sign-off

Different reviewer; revised PRD only; final score

# The Secondary Reviewer's Job

1. Read the **revised** PRD + the **resolution log**
2. Did the resolution log line up with the actual changes? (*Honesty check*)
3. Did revisions introduce new problems?
4. Are deferrals reasonable?
5. Score with the rubric — final number

**The secondary reviewer does not relitigate AM findings.** They evaluate the revised document on its own merits.



## Verdict + Sign-Off

### Score $\geq 3.0$

Ships as-is. Status:  
**Approved.**

### Score 2.0–2.9

Ships with named  
gaps captured in  
resolution log.  
Status: **Approved  
with gaps.**

### Score $< 2.0$

Needs further  
revision. Facilitator  
review.

## Activity 4 — Secondary Review

Single reviewing quad • 60 minutes

- 35 min: read revised PRD + resolution log; score
- 15 min: write Secondary Review Note (improved / still needs work / verdict)
- 10 min: deliver to authors + sign-off



35 + 15 + 10



# Week 3 Wrap

## What we shipped

- 11-section technical PRD per quad
- 2 primary reviews per PRD
- Author response conversation
- Secondary review + sign-off
- Mini-capstone delivered

## What opens Week 4

- **Technical Architecture & Constraints**
- Monolith vs microservices
- Security & compliance — revisited at architecture level
- System mapping; latency / availability targets
- AI restored; PRD becomes architecture input

**Bring to Monday:** your final PRD. The NFRs you wrote this week are the first draft of Week-4 architectural constraints.

# Questions & Reflection

What's the one finding from your review that will change how you write the next PRD?